

Blurry Assemblage

Shifting Landscape

She received a beautiful bracelet for her birthday, and she raked a comb through her hair.

◆ Bracelet ['breislət], noun

« a piece of jewelry worn on the wrist

◆ Comb [kəʊm], noun

¹ a flat piece of plastic or metal with a row of thin teeth that is used for making hair neat see picture at grooming

² a soft part on top of the head of some birds (such as chickens)

She wore glasses and a wig as a disguise, but the necklace was cursed.

◆ Wig [wɪɡ], noun

« artificial hair that you wear on your head because you are bald or in order to change your appearance compare

◆ Necklace ['nekləs], noun

« a piece of jewelry that is worn around your neck

A pile of books sat there, and use
scotch tape to seal the envelope,
snip, snip, went the scissors.

◆ Book [bʊk], noun

¹ a set of printed sheets of paper that are held together inside a cover, a long written work

² sometimes used figuratively

◆ Tape [keɪp], noun

¹ a long, narrow piece of material that is sticky on one side and that is used to stick things together

or to cover or repair something see

◆ Scissors [sɪzəz], noun

“ a tool used for cutting paper, cloth, etc., that has two blades joined together in the middle so that the sharp edges slide against each other

◆ Pen [pen], noun

¹ an instrument for writing or drawing with ink, typically consisting of a metal nib or ball, or a nylon tip, fitted into a metal or plastic holder

◆ Paperweight [ˈpeɪpəweɪt], noun

“ a small, heavy object that is used to hold down loose papers on a surface

Who nicked my pen?
That she uses as a paperweight.

The Post-it came unstuck, and your cell phone has vibrated several times, and he made a techscuse of looking up the word, but he was

◆ Post-it ['poust,ɪt], noun

“ a piece of paper with an adhesive strip on one side, designed to be stuck prominently to an object or surface and easily removed when necessary.

playing a game with his cell phone.

◆ Cellphone [ˈselfoʊn], noun

“ a phone with access to a cellular radio system so it can be used over a wide area, without a physical connection to a network;
a mobile phone

Is that a butterfly or a moth?

◆ Moth [mɒθ], noun

¹ an insect with two pairs of broad wings covered in microscopic scales, typically drably coloured and held flat when at rest. Moths are chiefly nocturnal, and lack the clubbed antennae of butterflies.

² a clothes moth

You were a man with a tumbler. But it's a novel book.

◆ Tumbler ['tʌmblə(r)], noun

¹ a glass used for drinking that has a flat bottom and no stem or handle

² a person who performs athletic movements that involve rolling or turning along the ground or through the air

She sucked a mint, and my gloves
have been missing for ages.

◆ Mint [mɪnt], noun

¹ an herb that has a strong pleasant smell and taste
and that is used in medicine and food

² a place where coins are made

◆ Glove [glʌv], noun

¹ a covering for the hand that has separate parts for each finger

² a very thick, padded covering for the hand that is worn in the sport
of boxing

A rubber band constricts what it
encircles, and he cracked the head
of the table with a ruler, until the
Post-it came unstuck.

◆ Rubber Band [ˌrʌbə 'bænd], noun

« thin, flexible loop that is made of rubber and used to
hold things together

◆ Ruler ['ru:lə(r)], noun

¹ a straight piece of plastic, wood, or metal that has marks on it to show units
of length and that is used to measure things

² a person (such as a king or queen) who rules a country, area, group, etc.



R1.

Gather the objects on your desk, or recall and list them. Each object must be three-dimensional (not flat). The desk can be your studio desk, a small IKEA desk in your room, or even the desk from your childhood that still remains at your parents' house.

R2.

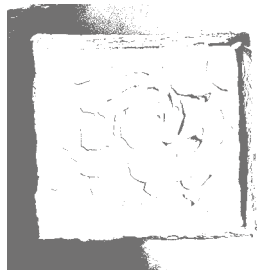
If the objects are physically present, arrange them into a panoramic composition. For any absent objects, imagine their form and tear paper to create their silhouettes. Place these torn silhouettes into the same panorama. Keep the arrangement as close as possible to the original composition of the desk.

R3.

For each object, collect a dictionary definition and an example sentence. Use a single dictionary source throughout for consistency. The example sentence should reflect the meaning of the word as you use it.

R4.

Link the example sentences in the same order as the objects are arranged in the panorama. Only minimal function words and punctuation are allowed in order to make the text readable (e.g., and, a, an, the, is, that, to, of, in, on, over, or, but, so, because, when, until, . ? ; :). The resulting linked text becomes the landscape's short story.

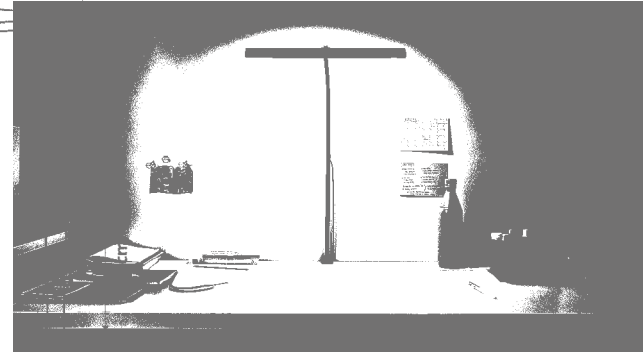
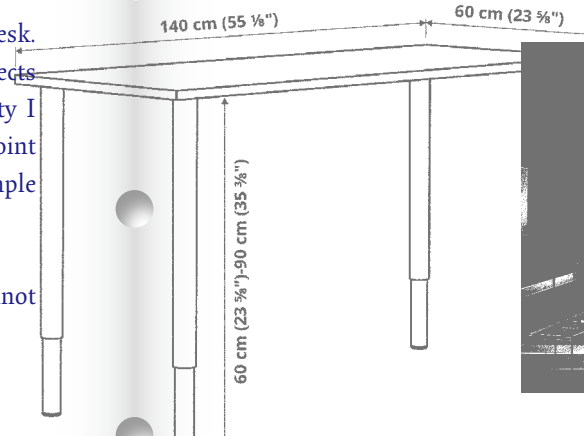


This short story is composed only of example sentences excerpted from a dictionary. In the landscape on the large piece of fabric, there is no perspective, and the forms are not clearly legible. We can only guess what is real, or what something real has been translated into. Is turning fragments of reality into a fictional story a lie, or another form of truth? Just as traditional East Asian landscape paintings could depict real scenery while removing perspective and layering scenes to produce an uncanny sense of the unreal, I wanted to test whether the accumulation and overlap of objective sentences could reveal gaps in reality.



All of the objects that appear in this landscape are things that actually sit on my desk. The desk can become a small stage under a single light, a bounded space where objects “enter” and draw attention the moment they are placed. One condition of unreality I set here is anonymity about where the events take place. Although the starting point is my personal space, the dictionary that contains the objects’ definitions and example sentences is thoroughly public and anonymous.

Because of that, the author of this story cannot be inferred, and its subjectivity cannot be traced. It is simply an unreality that begins from reality.





The book that contains this story is scaled to 1:10 of my actual desk and measures 140mm by 60mm. Through this procedure, an altered or reduced scale, writing with no identifiable author, and objects that overlap to form a new landscape. I wanted to slightly blur the boundary between reality and fantasy, and imagine the story that emerges as different layers are stacked and combined. ∴



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